

Second Term Examination – 2082

Class : XI

Subject: C. English (0031)

Full Marks: 75

Time: 3 hrs.

SET A

Pass Marks: 30

Candidates are required to give their answers in their own words as far as practicable. The figures in the margin indicate full marks.

1. Read the passage given below and answer the questions that follow.

The History of the Tortoise

A. If you go back far enough, everything lived in the sea. At various points in evolutionary history, enterprising individuals within many different animal groups moved out onto the land, sometimes even to the most **parched** deserts, taking their own private seawater with them in blood and cellular fluids. In addition to the reptiles, birds, mammals, and insects which we see all around us, other groups that have succeeded out of water include scorpions, snails, crustaceans such as woodlice and land crabs, millipedes and centipedes, spiders, and various worms. And we mustn't forget the plants, without whose prior invasion of the land none of the other migrations could have happened.

B. Moving from water to land involved a major redesign of every aspect of life, including breathing and reproduction. **Nevertheless**, a good number of thorough-going land animals later turned around, abandoned their hard-earned terrestrial retooling, and returned to the water again. Turtles went back to the sea a very long time ago, and, like all vertebrates that return to the water, they breathe air. However, they are, in one respect, less fully given back to the water than whales or dugongs, for turtles still lay their eggs on beaches.

C. There is evidence that all modern turtles are **descended** from a terrestrial ancestor that lived before most of the dinosaurs. There are two key fossils, called *Proganochelys quenstedti* and *Palaeochersis talampayensis*, dating from early dinosaur times, which appear to be close to the ancestry of all modern turtles and tortoises. You might wonder how we can tell whether fossil animals lived on land or in water, especially if only fragments are found. Sometimes it's obvious. Ichthyosaurs were reptilian **contemporaries** of the dinosaurs, with fins and streamlined bodies. The fossils look like dolphins, and they surely lived like dolphins, in the water. With turtles, it is a little less obvious. One way to tell is by measuring the bones of their forelimbs.

D. Walter Joyce and Jacques Gauthier, at Yale University, obtained three measurements in these particular bones of 71 **species** of living turtles and tortoises.

They used a kind of triangular graph paper to plot the three measurements against one another. All the land tortoise species formed a tight cluster of points in the upper part of the triangle; all the water turtles clustered in the lower part of the triangular graph. There was no overlap, except when they added some species that spend time both in water and on land. Sure enough, these amphibious species show up on the triangular graph **approximately** halfway between the ‘wet cluster’ of sea turtles and the ‘dry cluster’ of land tortoises. The next step was to determine where the fossils fell. The bones of *P. quenstedti* and *JR talampayensis* leave us in no doubt. Their points on the graph are right in the thick of the dry cluster. Both these fossils were dry-land tortoises. They come from the era before our turtles returned to the water.

E. You might think, therefore, that modern land tortoises have probably stayed on land ever since those early terrestrial times, as most mammals did after a few of them went back to the sea. But apparently not. If you draw out the family tree of all modern turtles and tortoises, nearly all the branches are **aquatic**. Today’s land tortoises constitute a single branch, deeply nested among branches consisting of aquatic turtles. This suggests that modern land tortoises have not stayed on land continuously since the time of *P. quenstedti* and *P. talampayensis*. Rather, their ancestors were among those who went back to the water, and they then re-emerged onto the land in (relatively) more recent times.

A. Mark the statements True, False, or Not Given.

[5×1=5]

TRUE If the statement agrees with the information given in the text.

FALSE If the statement contradicts the information given in the text.

NOT GIVEN If there is no information in the text.

- a. Animal migrations to land were only possible due to the presence of plants.
- b. Whales and dugongs do not return to land to reproduce as turtles.
- c. Modern land tortoises are the only animals to return to land from the sea.
- d. Ichthyosaurs from dinosaur time are the ancestors of the modern-day dolphins.
- e. Modern land tortoises have probably stayed on land ever since those early terrestrial times.

B. Choose among the highlighted words in the text that mean the same as the following definitions.

[5×1=5]

- a. (Of a plant or animal) growing or living in or near water:
- b. Deprived of natural moisture:
- c. In spite of what has just been said:
- d. A group of living organisms capable of exchanging genes:
- e. In a way that something is almost, but not completely, accurate or exact:

- C. Give short answers to the following questions in ONE SENTENCE each. [5×1 = 5]**
- What is common among all vertebrate animals that returned to the water?
 - What is the evidence that proves that early turtle ancestors lived on dry land?
 - How can the habitat of turtles be determined through fossil examination?
 - Why did Joyce and Gauthier research the bones of turtles and tortoises?
 - What does the "deeply nested" position of land tortoises suggest about their history?
- 2. Write short answers to the following questions in about 75 words each. [5×2 = 10]**
- How does Mrs. Wright's homesteading experience connect her to Mrs. Wright? (*Trifles*)
 - Who was Makar Semyonich and why did he murder a merchant? (*God Sees the Truth but Waits*)
 - How is oral tradition useful in terms of preserving one's culture? (*Sharing Tradition*)
 - What does Steve Jobs mean 'Don't Settle'? (*How to Live Before You Die*)
 - What is hyperbole? Elaborate it with examples from the poem '*A Red, Red Rose*'.
- 3. Write long answers to the following questions in about 150 words each. [2×5 = 10]**
- William Shakespeare in '*All the World's a Stage*' asserts that this world is a stage and all men and women are actors. What parts does a person play in his/her life?
 - Narrate the story '*The Oval Portrait*' as a horror story.
- 4. Write some paragraphs on 'Life Without Electricity' in about 150 words including title, topic sentences, and concluding sentences. [7]**
- 5. Suppose you got a wonderful gift on occasion of New Year 2026 from a relative you hardly liked. Write a letter to him/her mentioning your feelings about it and also thank him/her for everything. [8]**
- 6. Suppose you have been asked to deliver a speech in your school program on "The Role of Youth in Nation Building." Write the speech in about 300 words. [10]**

7. Do as directed and rewrite the sentences.

[10×1 = 10]

- a. I was interested in calligraphy class. (*Identify the word class of the underlined word.*)
- b. I never have understood her. (*Place the underlined word in the right position.*)
- c. Manish and Richa moved the table.....the dining room. (*Complete the following sentence using 'to', 'toward', 'onto', or 'into'.*)
- d. The dog(**bit**) his owner. (*Use the past form of the verb given in the brackets to complete the sentence.*)
- e. Perhaps she.....pass the exam. (*Complete the sentence using 'will' or 'be going to'.*)
- f. The jury..... (**has/have**) divided in their opinions. (*Complete the sentence using the correct verb from the brackets.*)
- g. The man with all his children.....(**live/lives**) in the town. (*Complete the sentence using correct verb from the brackets.*)
- h. He painted a picture. (*Underline the verb in this sentence and write whether it is **transitive**, **intransitive**, or **linking**.*)
- i. Listen! They(**fight**) on the ground. (*Use present simple or present continuous.*)
- j. You should study regularly to improve your grades. (*Put in 'had better' or 'should'.*)

8. Choose and copy the correct option.

[5×1 = 5]

- a. The word '**eloquent**' means:
 - i. having a wonderful personality
 - ii. the method of dressing
 - iii. a manipulative person
 - iv. fluent or persuasive in speaking or writing
- b. Which of the following words doesn't have any silent '**b**' letter?
 - i. subtle ii. doubt iii. robbed iv. debt
- c. Find the odd one out:
 - i. disloyal ii. disobey iii. distance iv. dishonest
- d. Choose the word with correct spelling.
 - i. transcendantel ii. transcendental
 - iii. transcedantel iv. transcendental
- e. Identify the word that ends with different sound.
 - i. dogs ii. cats iii. rooms iv. boys

ॐ - The End - ॐ